

INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Professional Development

PRINCIPLES OF FINANCE

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Describe crucial elements of a quality culture.
2. Demonstrate problem-solving skills.
3. Make decisions.
4. Employ communication styles appropriate to target audience.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of a loan processing assistant at FIRST HARBOR BANK. The branch manager (judge) wants your help solving a problem with loan applications.

Customers apply for car loans and personal loans at the branch. Last quarter, 14% of loan applications were sent back from the main office because of missing documents or mistakes. Each returned application delayed the customer's loan by an average of four days. Three customers filed complaints, and one customer took out a car loan at another bank instead.

The branch hired two new loan officers six months ago. Experienced employees say the new hires "don't follow the checklist," while the new hires say no one ever trained them on it. Some customers also say the bank's list of required documents is confusing.

The branch manager (judge) wants you to identify the cause of the problem, recommend a solution and explain how to build a culture where the branch gets things right the first time. The branch manager (judge) also wants to know how to share the plan with both the loan officers and the customers.

You will present your ideas to the branch manager (judge) in a meeting in the manager's office. The branch manager (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and answered the branch manager's (judge's) questions, the branch manager (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How do I talk with the experienced staff and the new hires without making either group feel blamed?
2. What would you tell a customer whose loan was delayed because of our mistake?

Rate the participant's ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Describe crucial elements of a quality culture.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
2.	Demonstrate problem-solving skills.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
3.	Make decisions.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
4.	Employ communication styles appropriate to target audience.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
SOLUTION						
4.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
5.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
7.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
8.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
10.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
					TOTAL SCORE	